# Naman Agrawal

CURRICULUM VITAE

na488@cornell.edu


## EDUCATION

**Ph.D., Neurobiology and Behavior, Cornell University** Expected May 2027

*Dissertation: Neural basis of spatial context-driven odor coding*

*Advisor: Dr. Christiane Linster*

**Integrated B.S.-M.S., Biology, IISER Kolkata** 2020

*GPA: 9.15/10.0 (absolute scale)*

*Master's Thesis: Identifying the descending neurons involved in turning behavior in Drosophila*

*Advisor: Dr. Bettina Schnell, Max Planck Institute for Neurobiology of Behavior, Bonn, Germany*

## POSITIONS HELD

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|---|---|
| Instructor of Record, BIONB 1220 - Big Brain Moments: A Logical History of Neuroscience | Spring 2025, 2026, Fall 2026 |
| Head Teaching Assistant, BIONB 2210 - Introduction to Behavior | Fall 2024, 2025 |
| Teaching Assistant, BIONB 2220 — Introduction to Neuroscience | Spring 2023, 2024 |
| Graduate Research Assistant, Neurobiology and Behavior, Cornell University | 2021 – present |

## RESEARCH AND TEACHING INTERESTS

• Introduction to Neuroscience • Introduction to Behavior • Systems Neuroscience

• Methods in Neuroscience • History of Biology and Neuroscience

## COURSES TAUGHT

BIONB 1220 — Big Brain Moments: A Logical History of Neuroscience (Instructor of Record; 18 students)

BIONB 2210 — Introduction to Behavior (Head TA; 140 students; facilitated active learning during lectures)

BIONB 2220 — Introduction to Neuroscience (Teaching Assistant; 30 students in discussion sections)

## PUBLICATIONS

**N. Agrawal**, O. D. Escanilla, D. E. Scott, L. M. Kay, D. M. Smith, T. A. Cleland, C. Linster (2026). Contextually driven communication between hippocampus and the olfactory system. Under review in *Scientific Reports*

Mahishi, D., **Agrawal, N.**, Jiang, W., Yapici, N. (2024). From Mammals to Insects: Exploring the Genetic and Neural Basis of Eating Behavior. *Annual Review of Genetics, 58(1), 455–485*.

Kim, H., Zhong, Z., Cui, X., Sung, H**., Agrawal, N**., Jiang, T., ... Yapici, N. (2024). HisCl1 Regulates Gustatory Habituation in Sweet Taste Neurons and Mediates Sugar Ingestion in Drosophila. *bioRxiv (preprint*).

## PRESENTATIONS

**Agrawal, N**., Dietz, S. (2026). An Open-Source Hands-On Module to Teach Basics of AI to Undergraduate Neuroscience Students. Poster presented at *SABER-East, 2026*.

**N. Agrawal**, O. D. Escanilla, D. E. Scott, L. M. Kay, D. M. Smith, T. A. Cleland, C. Linster (2025). Contextually driven communication between hippocampus and the olfactory system. Virtual Poster presented at *SfN, 2025*.

## AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

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| Cornelia Ye Outstanding International Teaching Assistant Award<br>Awarded annually to one international graduate teaching assistant at Cornell University in recognition of excellence in teaching and mentoring. | 2026 |
| SABER-East Travel Award<br>One of the six trainees who were awarded | 2026 |
| Graduate Teaching Fellow,<br>Center for Teaching Innovation, Cornell University | Fall 2025 – Spring 2026 |
| Department of Neurobiology and Behavior Graduate Fellowship | Fall 2021- Spring 2022 |

## LEADERSHIP, SERVICE AND COMMUNITY BUILDING

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| President – Graduate Student Improv Club | Fall 2022 – cont. |
| Librarian – NBB Graduate Student Society | Fall 2023 – Spring 2025 |
| NBB Departmental Symposium Organizing Committee | Spring 2025 |
| Vice President – Cornell India Association | Fall 2022- Spring 2023 |

Undergraduate Research Mentor:

Sophie Gustin (2023–2024);
Catherine Schweiger (2023);
Claire Makino Duan (2022–2023) (Honor's thesis);
Joshua Dov Epstein (2022–2023)

## CERTIFICATIONS AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

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| CIRTL - Planning Your Teaching-as-Research Project | Summer 2026 |
| Graduate Teaching Fellow, Cornell Center for Teaching Innovation (CTI) | Fall 2025 – Spring 2026 |
| CTI Summer Pedagogy Reading Group | Summer 2025 |
| CTI Early Graduate Teaching Cohort | Spring 2024 |
| CTI GET-SET Institute | Fall 2023 |
| **Courses** | |
| ALS 6014 — Theater Techniques for Enhancing Teaching and Public Speaking | Fall 2025 |
| WRIT 7100 — Teaching Writing | Fall 2024 |
| WRIT 7101 — Writing in the Majors Seminar | Spring 2023 |
| **Workshops** | |
| CSHL Neural Data Science | Summer 2025 |
| Neuromatch Academy- Computational Neuroscience | Spring 2022 |

## REFERENCES

**Dr. Christiane Linster**
Professor, Dept. of Neurobiology and Behavior, Cornell University | cl243@cornell.edu

**Dr. Hudson Kern Reeve**
Professor, Dept. of Neurobiology and Behavior, Cornell University | hkr1@cornell.edu

**Elliot Shapiro**
Teaching Professor, Director - Writing in the Majors, Cornell University | elliot.shapiro@cornell.edu